

🕒 Week 1 Revision Notes — The Tense Engine 🕒

Isaac's own copy · Keep this in your file · Read before homework & before every Headway quiz this term

📖 Booklet pp. 3-5

🎯 Goal: never write "have wrote" again

🌱 Based on YOUR real mistakes

● PART 1 · The One Image That Explains Everything

PAST ————— NOW ————— FUTURE

@cake eaten @he gets home
✓————→
↑ ↑
EARLIER past LATER past

"When he got home, the cake HAD already been eaten."

└─ ② simple past └─ ① earlier = had + V3

兩件過去嘅事，邊件先發生，邊件就用 **had + V3**。That's it. Past perfect = "before-ness". **One** past event by itself = simple past, no **had** needed.

● PART 2 · The 12-Box Grid (copy this into your notes by hand!)

	Simple	Continuous = in progress	Perfect = before-ness	Perfect Cont.
Past	V2 He <i>opened</i>	was/were + -ing	had + V3	had been + -ing
Present	V / V-s	am/is/are + -ing	have/has + V3	have been + -ing
Future	will + V	will be + -ing	will have + V3	will have been + -ing

⚡ 黃金法則 Golden Rule #1

The whole PERFECT column = **have-family + V3**. The moment you see **have / has / had / will have** → the next verb **MUST** be V3 (past participle). Never V2. 見到 **have** 家族，後面隻動詞即刻變 **V3**，冇例外。

⚡ 黃金法則 Golden Rule #2

The whole CONTINUOUS column = **be-family + -ing**. No be? No -ing. 「is investigate」呢類永遠錯 — 要麼 is investigating，要麼 investigates。

● PART 3 · The V3 Factory — Your Irregular Verb Families

Family	V1 → V2 → V3	Status
All Different ⚠ danger zone	write → wrote → written	你 8月15號寫咗 "have wrote" ✗
	take → took → taken	同 family 要小心
	break → broke → broken	同 family 要小心
	forget → forgot → forgotten	你 6月寫咗 "had not forgot" ✗
bring → brought → brought	✅ 你 8月已經 fix 咗！	
leave → left → left	✅ 你 8月已經 fix 咗！	
hit → hit → hit	✅ 你 8月已經 fix 咗！	

💡 **Chant 練法** Read each family aloud 3x: "write-wrote-written, write-wrote-written". Then cover, write from memory, check. 把口讀三次，蓋住默寫，對答案 — 考試嗰陣個 **sequence** 會自動彈出嚟。

● PART 4 · Signal Words = Tense Alarms 🚨

Signal words are cheats. When you see them in a cloze, the tense is basically decided:

Tense	Signal words
Simple past	yesterday last week ... ago in 1997
Past continuous	while at 6pm (past) when + interrupt
Past perfect	by the time before after already (past)
Present perfect	already yet just since ever / never (until now)

Pres. perf. continuous	all day for + duration since + start point
Future perfect	by Friday by the time + future by 2030

● PART 5 · Your Own Mistakes → Fixed Forever

✗ → ✓ Mistake #1 (Aug 15)

✗ "I have **wrote** three essays."

✓ "I have **written** three essays."

見到 have → 下一格必定 V3。wrote 係 V2，入唔到呢個位。

✗ → ✓ Mistake #2 (June 15 mock)

✗ "When we arrived, the film **was** already over — if she **was** more careful..."

✓ "the film **had** already **ended**... If she **had been** more careful..."

兩件過去事，早啲件用 had + V3。3rd conditional 嘅 if- clause 永遠係 had + V3 (你 8 月已經 15/15 全對，keep it up!)

✗ → ✓ Mistake #3 (Aug 15 — preview of Week 3)

✗ "The vaccine **was tested** when I visited the lab." (meaning: the testing was IN PROGRESS)

✓ "The vaccine **was being tested** when I visited."

動作進行中嘅被動式 = was/were + being + V3。Week 3 會全套教，呢家先記個樣。

● PART 6 · Final-Check Routine (考試前 30 秒做呢步)

- 🔍 Scan every verb: **have/has/had/will have** nearby? → next word MUST be V3.
- 🔍 he/she/it subject? → check the **-s** (your "the product **make**" → **makes** habit).
- 🔍 Two past events? → earlier one gets **had + V3**.
- 🔍 True/False question: before circling F, **can you NAME the error?** If you can't name it → it's T. **T 係正常答案，唔係陷阱！你 8 月嗰次將啲嘅句子圈錯咗。**

✍ 3-Minute Self-Test (answers upside-down at the bottom)

- She has _____ (take) the exam already.
- By the time the police arrived, the thief _____ (leave).
- While I _____ (do) my homework, my phone _____ (ring).
- True or False: "He had forgot his keys." _____
- Which signal word fits? "I have lived here _____ 2019." (for / since / ago)

Answers: 1. taken · 2. had left · 3. was doing / rang · 4. F (had forgotten) · 5. since